

UNION OFFICER (1812-85)

MAJOR MARTIN DELANY

The first Black field-grade officer in the history of the U.S. Army, Delany had been a prewar abolitionist and was among the first three Black men accepted to study medicine at Harvard. During the war he helped recruit thousands for the USCT Lincoln was impressed with him when they met in 1865, calling him a "most extraordinary and intelligent man." He was commissioned a major two weeks later, the highest rank attained by an Black American during the war.

